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New UAE-India MoUs to further strengthen ties

HAMDAN: SHARED DEDICATION TO SHAPE FUTURE THROUGH INNOVATION

MUMBAI
BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

In a landmark step to further strengthen the India-UAE partnership, eight agreements covering key sectors, including education, healthcare, and maritime cooperation among others were signed during an event hosted by Dubai Chambers in Mumbai.

Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister, and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Piyush Goyal, India's Minister of Commerce and Industry, witnessed the signing ceremony of Memorandums of Understanding (MoU). "India and the UAE are bound by a deep-rooted friendship and a shared dedication to shaping the future through innovation, opportunity, and sustainable growth," Shaikh Hamdan said.

One of the key agreements involved the Dubai Department of Economy and Tourism (DET) partnering with the Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad (IIM-A) to establish an international campus in Dubai. Initially, it will operate within the Dubai International Academic City and is expected to evolve into a permanent institution by 2029.

Dubai Chambers also signed three separate MoUs with the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry

KEY AGREEMENTS

- IIMA campus to be developed in Dubai in **2 phases**
- Dubai Chambers' **3 MoUs** with industry bodies
- DP World's **2 MoUs** with Indian companies
- Inclusive UAE-India Friendship Hospital in Dubai
- DMU, AIIMS to **enhance** research collaboration

(FICCI), and the IMC Chamber of Commerce and Industry.

High quality service

In the health care sector, Dubai Health announced the establishment of the UAE-India Friendship Hospital in Dubai. This not-for-profit initiative is designed to provide high-quality, affordable health care services.

Additionally, Dubai Medical University (DMU) and the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) signed an MoU to promote research collaboration and academic exchange.

In maritime collaboration, DP World and RITES, a leading Indian infrastructure consultancy, signed an MoU to build tech-driven supply chains.

Another significant MoU in the maritime sector was signed between Drydocks World, a DP World company, and Kerala's Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL).

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UAE MEDIATES US-RUSSIA PRISONER EXCHANGE

- The UAE's Ministry of Foreign Affairs announced the successful mediation of a prisoners' exchange between the United States and Russia. The process saw the exchange of one citizen each from both the countries, and was attended by representatives from both countries. The ministry expressed its appreciation to the governments of the US and the Russian Federation for the confidence placed in the UAE and for designating Abu Dhabi as the location for the exchange.

FULL REPORT ON P11

UAE, EU agree to launch CEPA negotiations

European Commission is nation's 2nd largest trading partner

ABU DHABI
BY KHITAM ALAMIR
Chief News Editor

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Ursula von der Leyen, President of the European Commission, have agreed to launch nego-

tiations on the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement, during a phone conversation.

Shaikh Mohammad stressed that CEPA will open new paths of cooperation between the UAE and the European Union.

The EU is the UAE's second-largest trading partner, accounting for 8.3 per cent of the UAE's total non-oil trade. In 2024, non-oil trade between the UAE and EU reached \$67.6 billion, representing 3.6 per

cent growth compared to the previous year.

The UAE is also the EU's largest export destination and investment partner in the Middle East and North Africa. By reducing tariffs and unnecessary trade barriers and improving market access for goods and services, the CEPA is expected to foster opportunities in key sectors such as advanced manufacturing, health care, logistics, and artificial intelligence, among others.

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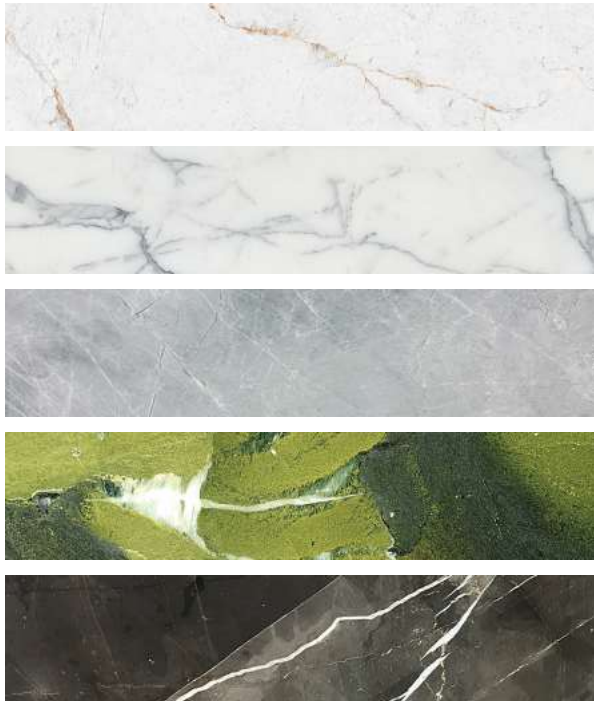
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